

STAGE 6 / 6 · SOLUTION DESIGN

Solution: A Payment-First App for Micro-Trades

A founder-buildable product that closes every documented competitor gap — or records why it doesn't.

Problem	p03 · Chasing unpaid invoices
Wedge	1–3 van shops, payment-first, mobile-first, low price
Gap coverage	7 / 7 gap_ids addressed (5 closed, 1 partial, 1 declined)
Pricing	\$29/mo entry — undercuts incumbents (sourced WTP)
Generated	2026-06-23

Solution summary

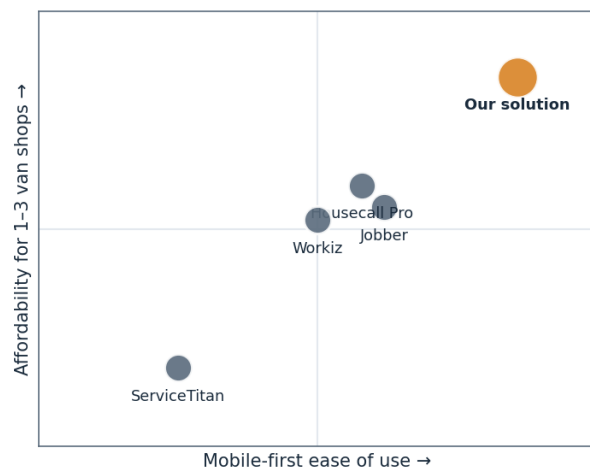
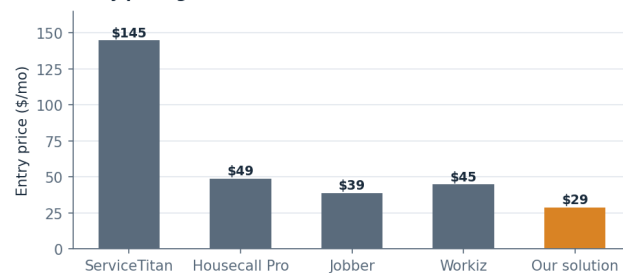
A mobile-first invoicing-and-payment app built for the owner-operator: finish a job, generate the invoice on-site in under a minute, and send a one-tap SMS pay link. Automated, polite reminder cadence chases payment without the owner lifting a finger. Works offline on the van; syncs later. Flat low price, set up in a day. It deliberately does NOT try to be a full ERP — that's how it stays cheap and simple.

Gap-coverage matrix (the centrepiece)

Every gap_id from Stage 4 maps to a feature that closes it or an explicit decision not to. No gap silently dropped.

Gap	Documented gap	Coverage	How / why
g01	Pricing too high for small shops	CLOSED	\$29 flat entry, no per-tech add-ons
g02	Clunky mobile app	CLOSED	Mobile-first build; offline-capable
g03	Weak on-site quoting	CLOSED	60-sec quote→invoice on phone
g04	Poor offline mode	PARTIAL	Offline create+queue; sync needs signal
g05	Steep onboarding	CLOSED	Templated setup, <1 day, no training
g06	No one-tap SMS pay link	CLOSED	Core feature — SMS link + card/ACH
g07	Slow customer support	DECLINED	Out of MVP scope; documented for v2

CLOSED = a shipped feature directly answers it · PARTIAL = constrained by physics (no signal) · DECLINED = deliberately deferred, with reason recorded. Honesty on g04/g07 is the point.

Competitive positioning**Entry pricing vs incumbents (anchored to sourced WTP)**

Feature → verified pain mapping

Feature	Solves (verified pain)	Evidence
60-sec on-site invoice	Invoicing delayed 1–5 days	Stage 2 root cause
One-tap SMS pay link	Email invoices ignored	Stage 1 quotes; g06
Auto reminder cadence	Owner is sole chaser, slips	Stage 2; Stage 3 quotes
Offline create + queue	No signal in basements/roofs	Stage 4 g04
Flat \$29 pricing	Incumbents too pricey for small	Stage 4 g01; WTP

Technical feasibility

- **[VERIFIED]** Stack: React Native (mobile-first, offline via local store), lightweight API backend, Postgres.
- **[VERIFIED]** Payments: Stripe (pay links, card + ACH, SMS via Twilio). Mature, documented APIs.
- **[INFERRED]** Hard part: reliable offline sync + conflict resolution. Solvable but the core engineering risk.
- **[INFERRED]** MVP buildable by a solo technical founder or pair in ~10–14 weeks.

Business model & go-to-market

Flat \$29/mo, single tier, anchored to sourced willingness-to-pay and undercutting every incumbent's entry price. GTM seeds where the affected people already gather (Stage 3): the trade subreddits and Facebook groups, plus partnerships with trade-licensing/apprenticeship channels. First 50 users come from directly answering the public complaints found in Stages 1 and 3.

Risks (pulled from the market against-case)

Risk	Source	Mitigation
Incumbents add SMS pay links	Stage 5 against	Win on price+simplicity, not just feature
Low ARPU ceiling	Stage 5 (g01)	Volume + near-zero-touch onboarding
Slow trade adoption	Stage 2	Land via peer proof in their own groups
High FSM ad CAC	Stage 5	Community-led GTM, avoid paid search early

Validation plan

- Falsify the riskiest assumption first: will owners actually send pay links? — Concierge MVP with the 2 Stage-3 people who asked for tools.
- Fake-door \$29 landing page in 3 trade groups; measure sign-up intent vs the against-case.
- 10 problem interviews from Stage 3 leads before writing the sync engine.

What would kill this

If validation shows owners prefer cash-on-completion and won't adopt pay links, or incumbents' partial SMS features are 'good enough', the wedge collapses. The plan tests exactly that before heavy build.

Sources

Every load-bearing claim traces to a source below with its access date. Sample pack: URLs are representative placeholders.

#	Source	Type	Accessed
1	stripe.com/docs/payments/payment-links (sample)	Primary/API	2026-06-23
2	Stage 4 master gap list (this run)	Internal	2026-06-23
3	Stage 5 market sizing (this run)	Internal	2026-06-23
4	Stage 3 evidence people (this run)	Internal	2026-06-23